the results of the virus passing through, as flu viruses do regularly. It is expected that it will be a one-off experience, so herd immunity will actually provide resistance to future visits by the virus.'[14] All across, the media headlines splashed that the UK was about to shut down schools and that £100 billion had been wiped off the value of leading shares after the government's warning of potential five lakh deaths.[15] This just about coincided with the US's Centers for Disease Control and Prevention's announcement of school closures, remote working and the Dow market crash.[16 17]

While the global search for information on the virus continued, experts had almost arrived at a consensus about transmission through aerosol droplets in human breath, echoing what our scientists had been indicating since several weeks now. The unresolved problem which remained and was more difficult to solve was to define the rate of asymptomatic infection. Three weeks after Lombardy locked down, all of Italy, following examples of Asian countries, had locked down.[18] An odd observation was the Europe Union's (EU) silence to Italy's request for help and the behaviour of every EU country which acted in its own interest by closing borders.[19] International collaboration was minimal.

Asian countries where the virus had made its presence were handling measures rather differently from the West. Based on its experience with SARS and MERS, South Korea, in one of its first steps, prepared itself to intensify aggressive testing in over 50 laboratories.[20] Seoul's authorities were empowered to compel every infected person to move without their family to a special quarantine accommodation/facility for two weeks. In addition to this, they were using facial recognition on CCTV, personal data from credit card transactions and technology to identify anyone who the infected person would have come in contact with to track, test and quarantine.[21] Due to this measure, and strict COVID-19 behaviour protocols, they were able to avoid a national lockdown and keep casualties at about 10 per day. Singapore and Taiwan had only two deaths at this point; the former had opted to keep schools and restaurants open and was actively discouraging remote working to protect the economy, while the latter had introduced mass temperature screening while keeping shops and restaurants open.[22]